preceding independence. Once an independent state had been achieved, Muhammad Ali Jinnah, founder of Pakistan and Pakistan's first governor general, regarded all identities as subservient to Islam, and regionalism was seen as negative and detracting from Islamic unity. 'So what is the use of saying we are Bengalis, or Sindhis, or Pathans, or Punjabis? No, we are Muslims' (quoted in Adeney 2004, p. 166). Although denying the legitimacy of provincial claims for recognition would have been consistent with Jinnah's positive exclusivism, the disparity in the treatment of the regions that developed was not (Adeney 2009). Pakistan struggled with the balance of power between the region and the state, and regional conflicts delayed the first constitution by nine years. Ultimately, the nation was not able to effectively balance the call for regional autonomy with the power of the state. The institutions that rose to power in Pakistan engendered much resentment as they were ethnically dominated. The military in particular was controlled by a disproportionate number of Punjabis. This situation alienated other ethnic groups, especially the Bengali majority group, notably under-represented in the government, and increased the intensity of the divisive forces for regionalism. In addition, a relative paucity of economic wealth was apportioned to Pakistan after partition. This wealth, in turn, was unevenly concentrated and invested in the western wing of the country, only furthering provincial tensions (Talbot 1998). Even the ideology of 'Islamic Socialism' under Zulfikar Ali Bhutto failed to cut across ethnic structures. In the elections of 1970, Bhutto's support was mainly from Punjab and Sindh, not Balochistan, North-West Frontier Province (NWFP – now Khyber Pakhtunkhwa (KP) since 2010) or East Pakistan.

Ethnic Punjabi bias became synonymous with a class bias in the new state. For many Punjabis, there is no conflict between a Punjabi and a Pakistani identity, with the exception of the Siraiki belt, and there is a movement for Siraiki to be declared an independent province from Punjab (Birmani 2018). To this day there are ethnic divisions and grievances based on provincial origin. They are very real, as evident in the renaming of NWFP to KP as well as the flaring up of Balochistan's insurgency, and more recently the PTM. However, there are many cases of compatible and superimposed ethnic identities.

Religious conflict – Pakistan through the prism of sectarian conflict

Pakistan was conceived as a homeland for Muslims in South Asia. The first sectarian conflict emerged in 1953, about the Ahmadiyas in the Punjab. In 1974, under the democratically elected left-leaning Z. A. Bhutto, the government